



golden
pumpkin



CHANDER MOHAN A.K.A CHAND MOHAMMAD

THIS WAS one romance that spelt doom from the moment the words "I do" were muttered. Haryana Deputy Chief Minister Chand Mohan has taken the unpredictable nature of state politics to new heights. Missing for the last six weeks, the already-married Mohan and father of two teenaged kids popped up before a TV camera to drop the bombshell: he had married again, his new wife being Anuradha Bali, an ex-state government official. Both converted to Islam and rechristened themselves Chand Mohammad and Fiza. Mohammed has been stripped of deputy chief ministership "because of his prolonged absence from office" said Chief Minister B.S. Hooda. Left red-faced by his son's peccadilloes, Haryana Congress strongman Bhajan Lal disowned him. While Chand Mohammad may find himself in a bigamy mess, his political career has ended even before his second honeymoon began.



BANGALORE | Yes She Can

After getting two of his sons into politics, former prime minister and JD(S) honcho H.D. Deve Gowda has now cleared the way for his son and former chief minister H.D. Kumaraswamy's wife Anitha to file her nominations for the Madhugiri Assembly byelection on December 27. Both Kumaraswamy and his brother H.D. Revanna have held top portfolios at the state level—Revanna was minister for power and PWD minister twice. Anitha is a computer engineer and currently the managing director of Kasturi Media that also runs a Kannada television channel in the state.

by Stephen David



ANITHA AND KUMARASWAMY

B.K. RAMESH

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thousand commandos will be raised by the railways at a cost of Rs 60 crore to protect stations.



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A SUSPECT

DELHI | Cover Capers

Forget a unified agency for investigating terrorism in India, the police forces and security agencies can't even settle on a common hood for suspects. Some LET collaborators in Kolkata were hooded in colourful pillow covers. Last week, some suspects were produced with towels around their faces giving a whole new meaning to the word towelhead (derogatory for turbaned Arabs and Asians). The police's creativity has the potential for creating social unrest—Delhi Police's Special Cell produced Indian Mujahideen suspects draped in keffiyahs leading to accusations of labeling a community. *by Sandeep Unnithan*

DELHI

Home Match

For the BJP's O.P. Babbar, this was his eighth straight win in the assembly elections, but the first in which he faced an in-house opponent, daughter-in-law Anita Babbar. "It's a political fight which will not affect equations at home," said the graceful winner. *by Rahul Tewari*



REKHA